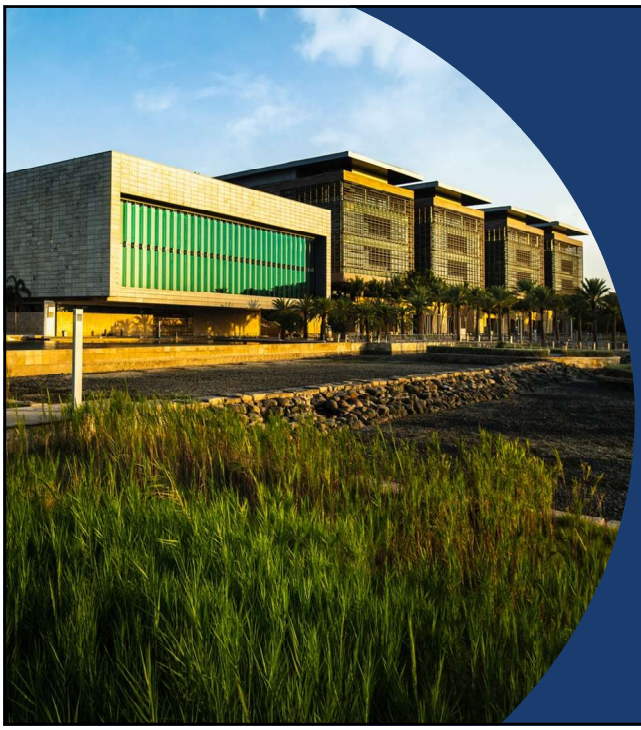

جامعة الملك عبدالله للعلوم والتقنية
King Abdullah University of Science and Technology

KSA UNIVERSITIES

DEVELOPING ACADEMIC LEADERS PROGRAM,

Day 1

Leading Self, Leading Others and Developing High Performing Teams

Professor Jonathan Grant
Dr Tom Kennie &
Dr Sara Hurley

أكاديمية كاوست
KAUST ACADEMY

1

DAY 1 – MONDAY 30TH MARCH - am

جامعة الملك عبدالله للعلوم والتقنية
King Abdullah University of Science and Technology

01 Agenda Setting

02 Foundations of Academic Leadership

03 The Debate

04 Some Conceptual Models

05 Leading Academics - Reflections

06 BREAK

2

DEVELOPING ACADEMIC LEADERS PROGRAM

THE 'WHAT'?

Developing Six Core Capabilities: TODAY

Leading Self

- *Understanding your leadership strengths and preferences*

Leading Others

- *Leading Academics*
- *Leading Academic Teams*

Leading Strategic Change

- *Leading Strategically*
- *Leading Academic Change*
- *Leading Social Impact*

Each capability builds on self-awareness and strengthens your overall leadership effectiveness

| 3

3

Our Ways of Working

4

ORIENTATION TO PROGRAM

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King Abdullah University of Science and Technology

Your Areas of Interest

- What attracted you to the program?
- What themes/topics are of particular interest?
- What questions would you like to explore during the program?
- What would a successful program experience look like, feel like?

5

Reflections and Emergent Themes from Orientation Session - 1

- Emphasis on improving and enhancing current understanding
- A desire to share together responses to common challenges
- An interest in the challenges (and opportunities) of leading as 'A First'
- Understanding more about financial responsibilities and governance
- ...

6

Reflections and Emergent Themes from Orientation Session - 2

- Influencing and shaping organisational culture
- Dealing with resistance to change
- Empowering women in leadership roles
- Gaining global insights relevant to a local context
- Building partnerships, collaborations and alliances
- Finding tools which can be applied to your context during the program
- Become an (even better) version of myself as a leader
- ....

7

Reflections and Emergent Themes from Orientation Session - 3

- Understanding more about the 'outer circle' beyond your local context - across KSA and globally
- Leading and leadership within and across the wider community beyond the university
- Understanding even more about international standards of leadership
- Deepening understanding of different leadership frameworks
- The delicate balances to be struck in the different aspects and demands of different leadership roles
- ...

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DAY 1 – MONDAY 30TH MARCH

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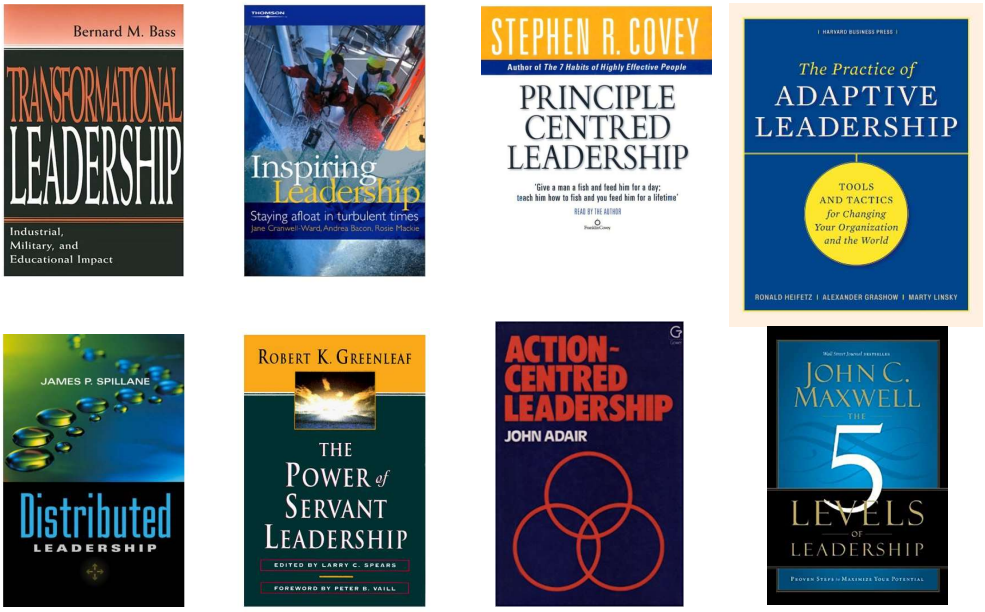

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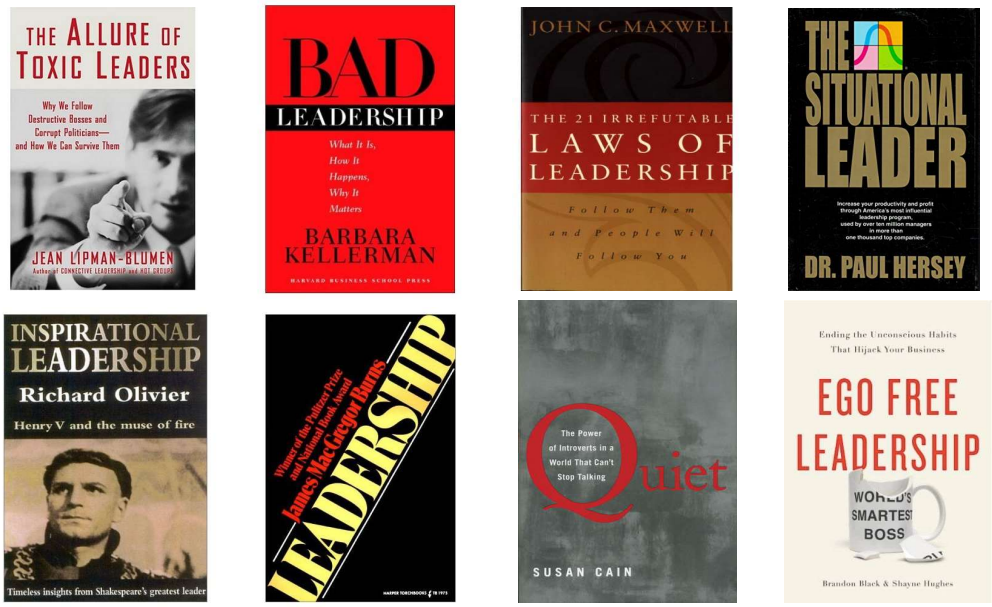
THE ALLURE OF TOXIC LEADERS
Why We Follow Destructive Bosses and Corrupt Politicians—and How We Can Survive Them
JEAN LIPMAN-BLUMEN
BAD LEADERSHIP
What It Is, How It Happens, Why It Matters
BARBARA KELLERMAN
JOHN C. MAXWELL
THE 21 IRREFUTABLE LAWS OF LEADERSHIP
Follow Them and People Will Follow You
THE SITUATIONAL LEADER
DR. PAUL HERSEY
INSPIRATIONAL LEADERSHIP
Richard Olivier
Henry V and the muse of fire
Timeless insights from Shakespeare's greatest leader
LEADERSHIP
James MacGregor Burns
Quiet
The Power of Introverts in a World That Can't Stop Talking
SUSAN CAIN
Ending the Unconscious Habits That Hijack Your Business
EGO FREE LEADERSHIP
SMARTEST BOSS
Brandon Black & Shayne Hughes

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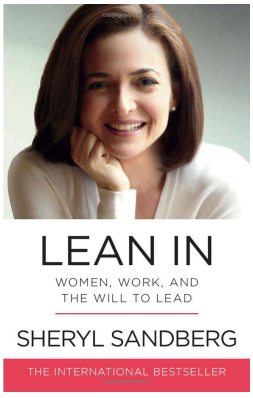
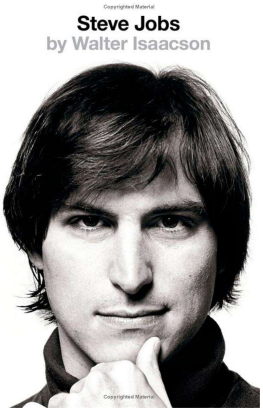
Followership
BARBARA KELLERMAN
FOLLOW
LEAD
THE COURAGEOUS FOLLOWER
STANDING UP TO AND FOR OUR LEADERS
IRA CHALEFF

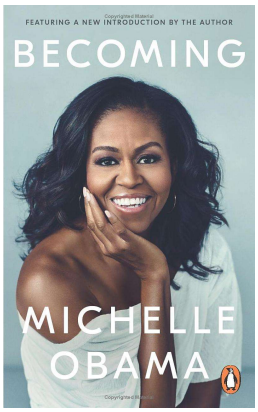
12

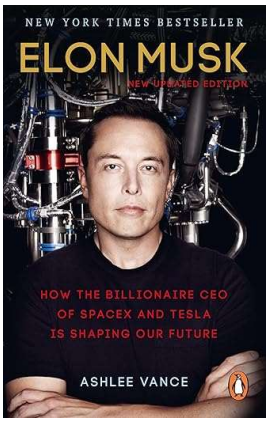
Much written by and about political leaders…

MUCH WRITTEN BY AND ABOUT BUSINESS LEADERS









Forbes | New Posts +13 posts this hour | Most Popular Highest-Paid Athletes | Lists Most Powerful Women | Video Highest-Paid Athletes | Search

The Toughest Leadership Job Of All (It's Not What You Think)

We revere the skills of prominent CEOs, perhaps more than we should.

We romanticize Steve Jobs types, who scream at their underlings until they squeeze sheer perfection out of them.

We lionize Jack Welch, who earned the nickname "Neutron Jack" for his ability to get rid of employees while leaving only the corporate offices standing.

But there's an underappreciated form of leadership that requires far more skill than being a CEO does. It's the job of a university president.

(**Source**: Asghar, R. (November, 2013). *The Toughest Leadership Job Of All (It's Not What You Think)*. Forbes)

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Forbes | New Posts +13 posts this hour | Most Popular Highest-Paid Athletes | Lists Most Powerful Women | Video Highest-Paid Athletes | Search

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Nonsense its being a Dean in a university or a senior leader in a Ministry now that's tough…but also a great privilege

(**Source**: Asghar, R. (November, 2013). *The Toughest Leadership Job Of All (It's Not What You Think)*. Forbes)

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LEADERSHIP IN HIGHER EDUCATION
THE DEBATE

17

LEADING IN A HE CONTEXT: THE DEBATE

FRANKLY, LEADING IN A HE, PARTICULARLY IN UNIVERSITIES, IS REALLY *NO DIFFERENT* FROM ANY OTHER CONTEXT AND IT'S ABOUT TIME WE REALISED THAT, FOR EXAMPLE…

LEADING IN A HE CONTEXT, PARTICULARLY IN UNIVERSITIES IS *VERY DIFFERENT* FROM LEADING IN OTHER CONTEXTS AND IT'S REALLY IMPORTANT TO BE AWARE OF THESE DIFFERENCES,
FOR EXAMPLE….

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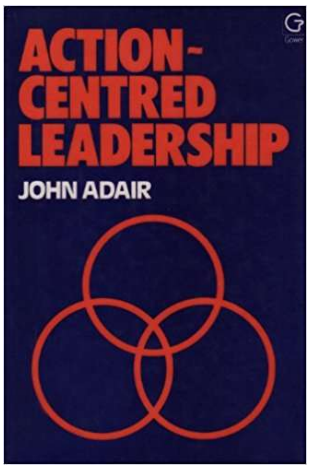
LEADERSHIP IS *GENERIC* NOT CONTEXTUAL



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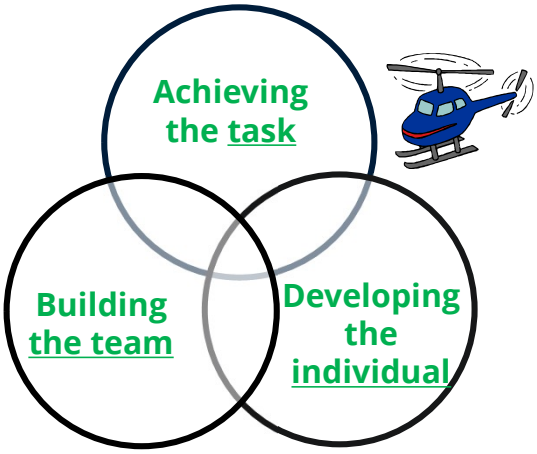
GENERIC MODELS
ACTION CENTRED LEADERSHIP (ACL)

The Delicate Balancing Act

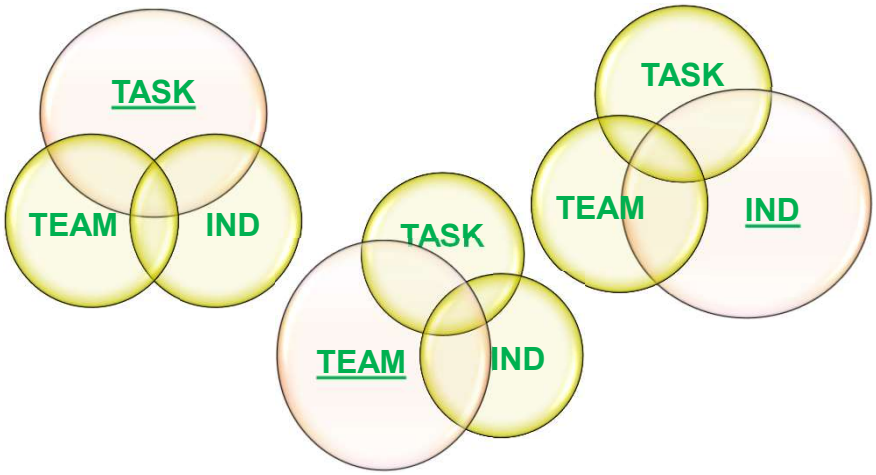


(after John Adair)

21

GENERIC MODELS
ACTION CENTRED LEADERSHIP (ACL)

GETTING THE BALANCE RIGHT



(after John Adair)

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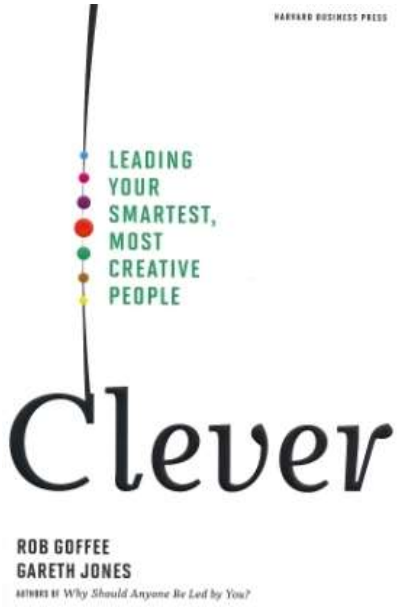

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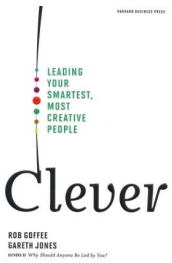
Leading *C*lever People

- ***Clever*** **people are often a mass of contradictions:**
- **They don't like organisations, but need to belong**
- **They don't like leadership, but need to be led**
- **They don't like limits, but need to know where the boundaries are**
- **They don't like administration, but expect to be served**
- **They don't like fixed goals, but want to have an impact**
- **They don't like feedback, but crave recognition**



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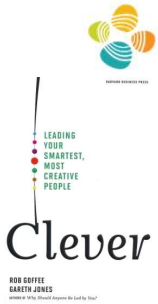
Leading Clever People



- Their cleverness is central to their identity
- Their skills are not easily replicated
- They know their worth
- They ask difficult questions
- They are not impressed by corporate hierarchy (and they don't want to be led)
- They expect instant access
- They want to be connected to other clever people
- They won't thank you

(Rob Goffee and Gareth Jones – 2009)

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Leadership in Higher Education

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Leadership in Higher Education
Not a One Size Fits All Approach

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Leadership in Higher Education
The Balance Varies and Changes

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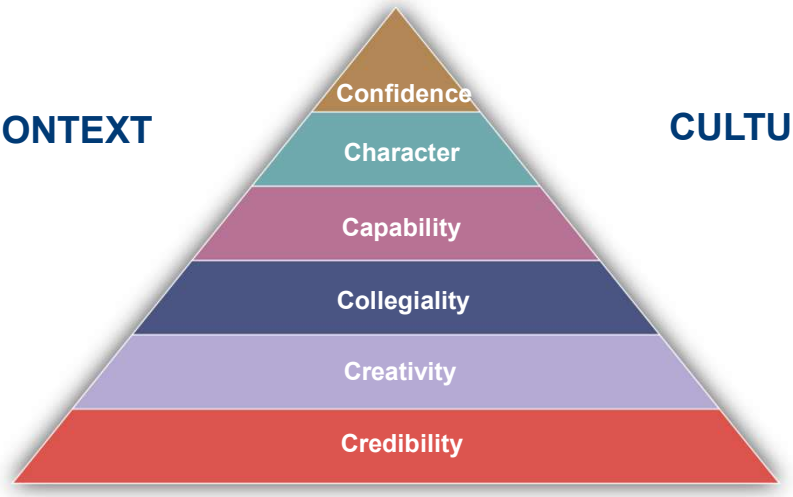
6 Dimensions of Academic/Professional Leadership

CONTEXT



CULTURE/S

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CREDIBILITY

Where does it come from?

- Personal (intellectual) credibility
- Professional credibility
- Peer credibility, delivery credibility
- Positional (management) credibility
- **Political credibility**

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CREATIVITY

Challenge

- Effective leaders articulate the BHAG
- The Big Hairy Audacious Goal – YUCK!
- The Big Hairy *Academic/Professional* Goal?

Connections

- Effective leaders display an infectious fascination for their discipline/professional area
- Really effective leaders also display this in relation to the *other disciplines/professions* in their area

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CAPABILITIES

- Horizon scanning
- Sense making
- Strategizing
- Planning, and
- Executing

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CAPABILITIES

1. CROSS-CULTURAL UNDERSTANDING – WIDENING YOUR CULTURAL 'BANDWIDTH'
2. CAN DO – BOTH IN ATTITUDE AND IN YOUR PLANS
3. COALITION BUILDING – FINDING MUTUAL 'WIN-WIN' OUTCOMES WITH PARTNERS
4. CONFLICT RESOLVING – AWARE OF THE OPTIONS TO DEAL WITH POTENTIAL CONFLICT AND SKILLS TO APPLY THESE
5. CELEBRATING – TAKING TIME TO RECOGNISE PROGRESS ON THE JOURNEY
6. CAPABLE OF STANDING BACK – TAKING A HELICOPTER VIEW

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ranmore
Confidence
• Internal
• External
35

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WHICH ARE YOUR STRENGTHS?
Credibility
Character
Creativity
Collegiality
Confidence
Capability

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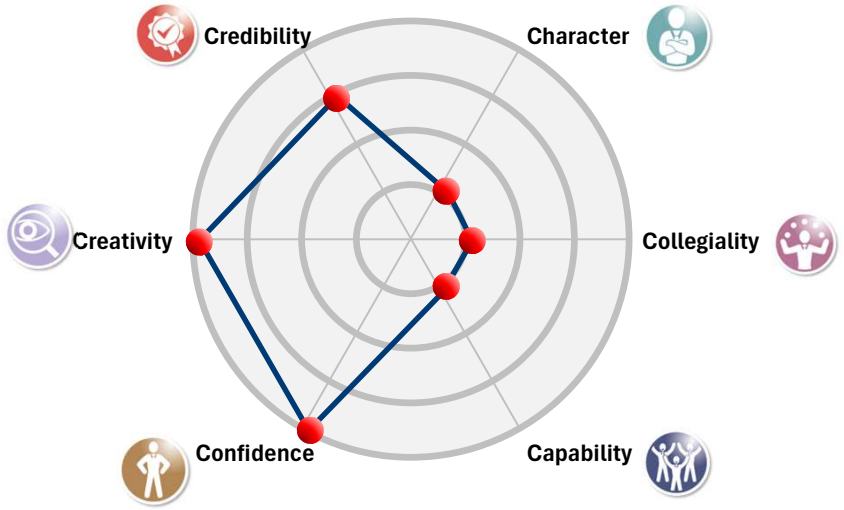
The Dynamics:

What issues might this pattern raise?



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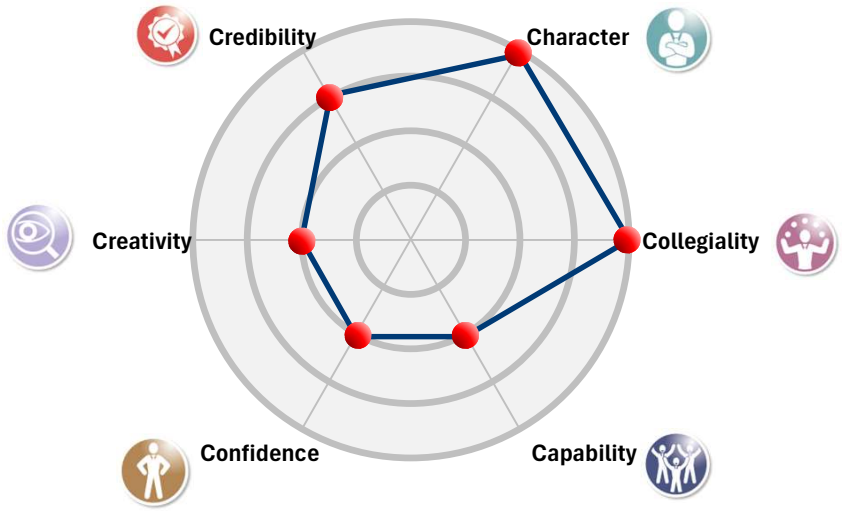
The Dynamics:

What issues might this pattern raise?



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DAY 1 – MONDAY 30TH MARCH

جامعة الملك عبدالله للعلوم والتقنية
King Abdullah University of Science and Technology

01 Leading Self – 1: Understanding 'the what'

02 Understanding Your Role

03 The Dimensions & Dilemmas

04 Leading Self – 2: Understanding 'the how'

05 Reflections on Your Team Leadership Profile

06 From Your Personal to Our Team Profile

07 LUNCH

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WHAT DO *YOU* DO?

I'm a *Dean?*

A what? *what's that?*

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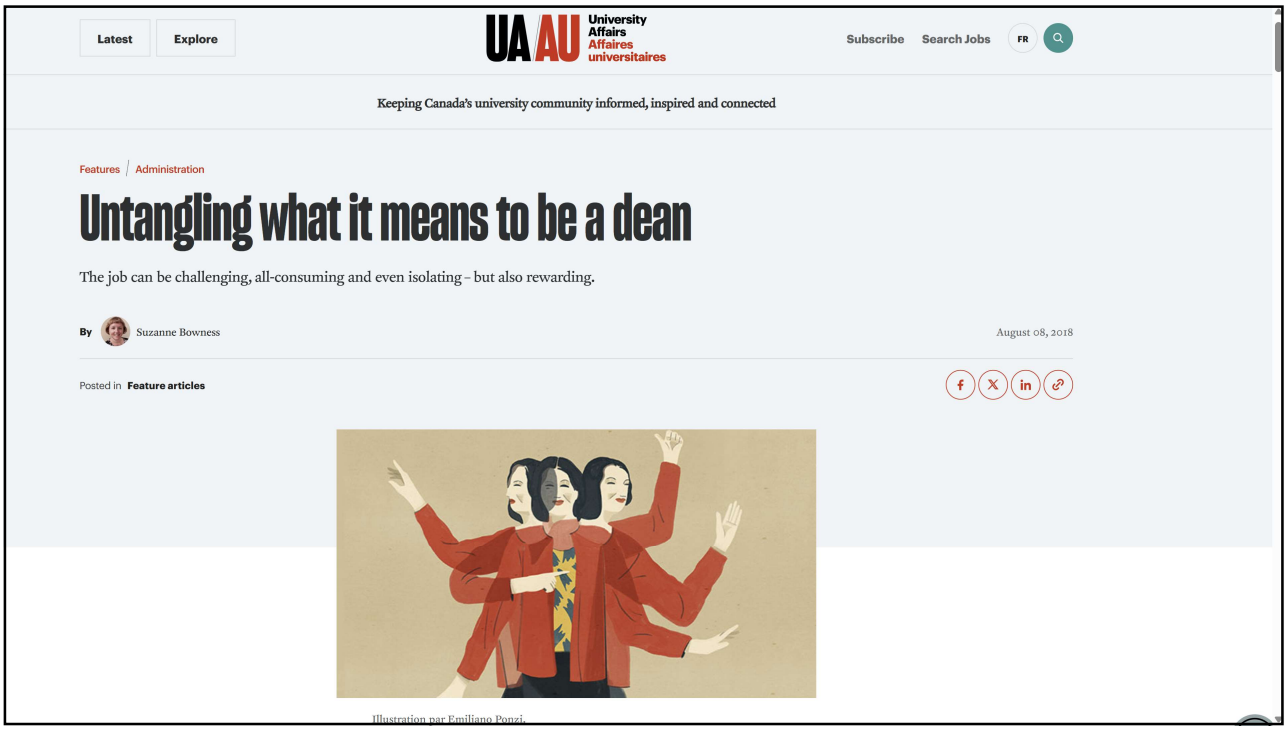

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"We're the communicators of the vision of the university from the senior leadership side, and the needs of the faculty on the other end, balancing constantly between these two worlds."

"It's a 15-hour day on a regular basis. And apart from the day-to-day putting out of fires, you have to have your eye on longer-term strategy."

"You need to be someone who rallies people together. There are times when you have to give your troops a morale boost and act as a model of resilience, facing these things with a smile."

"Especially in the first year, just get out of your office. Go to everything, meet as many people as you can, and listen."

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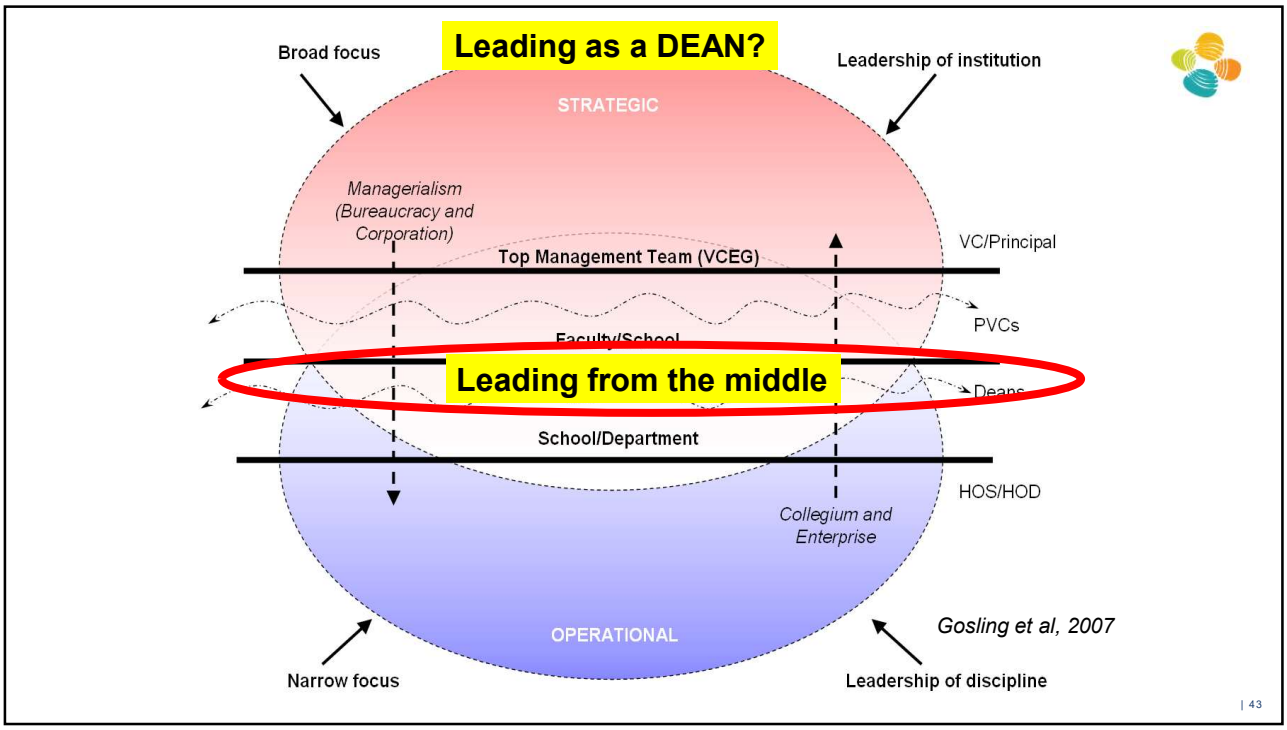
Leading as a DEAN?
Broad focus
Leadership of institution
STRATEGIC
Managerialism
(Bureaucracy and
Corporation)
Top Management Team (VCEG)
VC/Principal
PVCs
Faculty/School
Leading from the middle
Deans
School/Department
HOS/HOD
Collegium and
Enterprise
OPERATIONAL
Gosling et al, 2007
Narrow focus
Leadership of discipline
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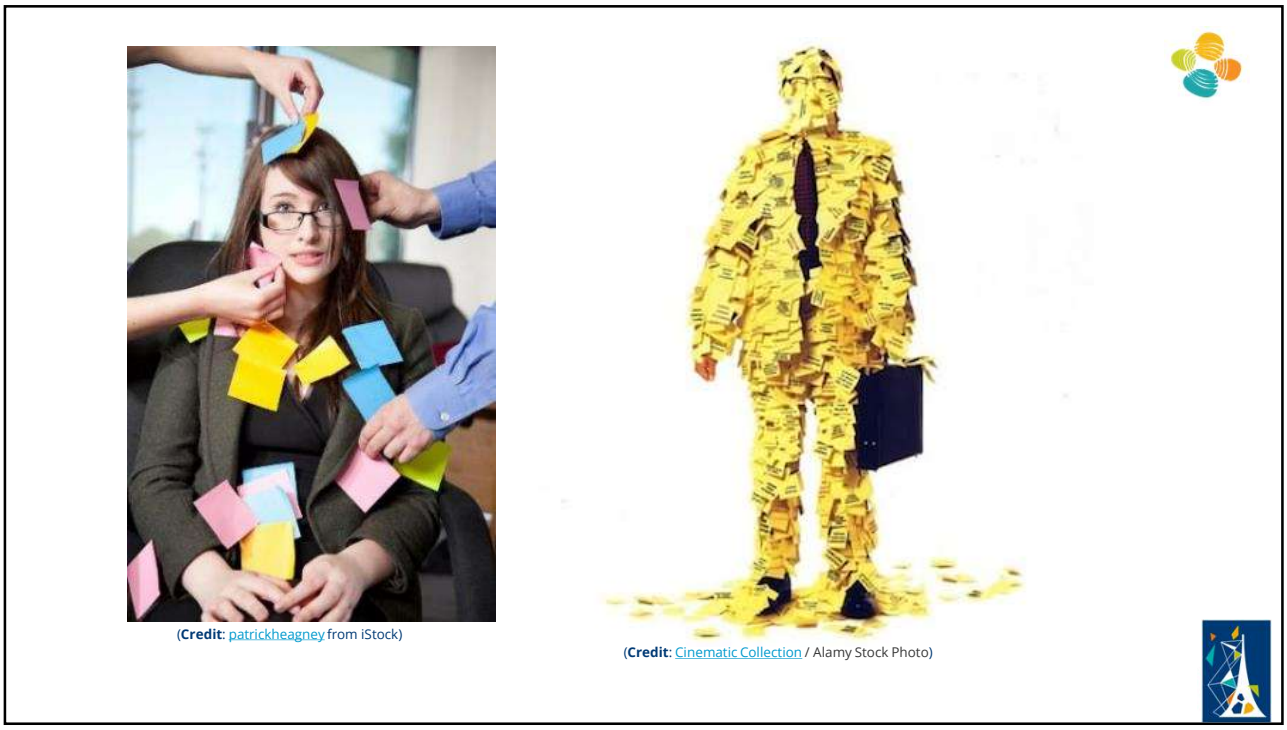
(Credit: patrickheagney from iStock)
(Credit: Cinematic Collection / Alamy Stock Photo)

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‘LEADING SELF’ UNDERSTANDING ‘THE WHAT’

THE DIMENSIONS & DILEMMAS OF DEANSHIP

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DIMENSIONS

1. Strategist/Strategic Planner			
2. Academic/Professional Leader			
3. Architect of major transformative/recovery planning within Faculty			
4. Implementer of University Policy			
5. Leading Cross-Faculty/University Projects			
6. Leading the Faculty Executive Leadership Team			
7. Talent and People Manager			
8. Resource Manager			

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DIMENSIONS

10. Identifying and Managing Risks			
11. Leading on Communication Issues			
12. Capital Projects Manager			
13. Advocate			
14. Ambassador			
15. Marketeer/Business Developer			
16. Entrepreneur/Fundraiser			
17. Leading externally – where?			
18. Oh…and not forgetting researcher, teacher, professional ….			

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THE DIMENSIONS & DILEMMAS OF DEANSHIP

Role Expectation	1.My Strengths *(My perception of what I'm good at and would like to do more of over the next 12 months?*	2. My Priorities *(My perception of the top 6 priorities required to enable the Faculty to flourish over the next 12 months?*	3. Line Manager Priorities *(My perception of my line managers top 6 priorities for me over the next 12 months?*

- How closely aligned are your priorities with your perception of your line managers expectations?
- How aligned are your preferences with the priorities required by the Department, Division or Unit?

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ISSUES ARISING

- Areas of personal development,
  - What might I need to do more of,
  - What might I need to gain more experience of?
  - Are there possible areas in which I might need to enhance my existing skills?

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'LEADING SELF'

INSIGHTS ABOUT YOUR PRIORITIES AND EXPECTATIONS: UNDERSTANDING 'WHAT' YOU DO YOUR LEADERSHIP ROLE

THE DIMENSIONS & DILEMMAS OF DEANSHIP

Consider the following dimensions that describe 18 possible expectations associated with the role as Dean. Whilst recognising that all the elements are important,

1. What do you perceive to be the **role priorities** which are needed to **enable your Faculty to flourish** over the forthcoming **1-2 years**? (say top 5)
2. What are your **strengths** and areas where **you'd prefer to focus** over the next 1-2 years? (top 5)
3. **Where are the potential gaps** you need to fill? **Who can help you?**

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THE MANY EXPECTATIONS ON MINISTERS

Consider the following dimensions that describe 18 possible expectations associated with your role within the Ministry. Whilst recognising that all the elements are important,

1. What do you perceive to be the **role priorities** which are needed to **enable your portfolio to flourish** over the forthcoming **1-2 years**? (say top 5)
2. What are your **strengths** and areas where **you'd prefer to focus** over the next 1-2 years? (top 5)
3. **Where are the potential gaps** you need to fill? **Who can help you?**

Role Expectation	1.My Strengths *(My perception of what I'm good at and would like to do more of over the next 12 months?*	2. My Priorities *(My perception of the top 6 priorities required to enable my portfolio to flourish over the next 12 months?*	3. Line Manager Priorities *(My perception of my line Ministers top 6 priorities for me over the next 12 months?*

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